Anti-Smoothing: Clients, Markets, and Business Model

Investment Thesis and Commercial Plan

The AI service that keeps the conditions, evidence, and consequences of collaboration visible.

Specialist startup • Integrable product • Decentralized brand

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1. The Business Thesis

Anti-Smoothing is a service that checks fidelity among evidence, promises, and the conclusions on which people base their collaboration. The customer buys a verifiable record of things that can change a decision: conditions missing from an offer, results stated more strongly than the tests warrant, omitted responsibilities, alternatives removed, or uncertainties turned into certainties.

The offer is not “an AI that tells the truth.” It is a bounded procedure: authorized sources, explicit questions, pinpointed observations, a right of reply, and a conclusion proportionate to the available evidence. The procedure can be applied before a decision or repeated throughout a project.

The launch recommendation is a service for companies delivering B2B AI and software projects: checking the transition from demonstration to commercial commitment. The second market is quality control for research and analysis reports. API integration is an extension after product validation, not the first thing to build. General employee surveillance, automated arbitration, and political evaluation should be excluded from the launch.

The Commercial Outcome Being Sold

For a supplier, the product can make an offer more credible and easier to accept: limitations are explicit, evidence can be found quickly, and the customer need not assume that every favorable phrase conceals a problem. For a buyer, the product clarifies what is being approved, what remains unproven, and which conditions must be retained in the agreement. For both parties, later monitoring can prevent their two versions of the same project from diverging.

Higher commercial conversion, shorter approval times, and fewer rounds of rework are value hypotheses, not demonstrated results. The business deserves to be built only if such effects appear against the customer's usual review process at an acceptable total cost.

Investment Decision	Proposed Position
Initial Offer	Paid review of an AI/software dossier before acceptance, expansion, or contracting.
Initial Buyer	Delivery director, founder, or chief technology officer of a supplier with recurring projects.
Recurring Revenue	Subscription for a repeated document flow; later, a bilateral project space.
Starting Price	EUR 1,500 for one dossier; EUR 1,290 per month for a team package. Hypotheses to test.
Initial Investment	Human-assisted delivery on existing infrastructure, without a proprietary foundation model.
Condition for Expansion	Customers who repurchase, accurate material observations, and sustainable economics after human review.
The Consortium's Role	Distribution and specialization through independent operators with shared assets and rules. It is not needed for the first sale.

Three Possible Businesses, Not One Financial Valuation

A **specialist startup** can build a profitable service for a niche and control quality directly. A **product company** can later distribute the verification engine through other applications. A **decentralized brand** can bring together operators who sell and deliver in different languages, sectors, and jurisdictions. Revenue earned by all operators is not revenue earned by the company maintaining the shared infrastructure.

The three structures may emerge in sequence, but they need not be funded at the same time. At the start, proof that one customer pays for a review, uses its findings, and returns is enough. Financing a universal protocol before that proof would turn organizational research into a premature commercial expense.

Status of the Figures in This Book

External data are identified by numbered references. Prices, conversion rates, costs, eligibility filters, and projections are **planning assumptions**, not existing traction or market-validated offers. All amounts are in EUR, excluding VAT. The scenarios are not a financial valuation of an existing company.

The choice of niches is an investment judgment: it favors access to evidence, purchase frequency, clear responsibility, and the possibility of starting with little capital. It is not presented as the result of a willingness-to-pay study.

2. The Product a Customer Can Buy

A Material Difference, Not Imperfect Wording

In this offer, smoothing means the loss or weakening of information that matters to a decision when sources are turned into summaries, promises, reports, or explanations. Not every simplification is a problem. Communication can become shorter and more cooperative without losing the terms of an agreement. The distinction between useful simplification and removal of relevant structure is the service's conceptual foundation. [1]

The product looks for **material differences**. A difference is material if it could change acceptance of an offer, price, timing, responsibility, required tests, or the manner of execution. Detecting an optimistic adjective unrelated to such a consequence does not justify an alert to the customer.

The unit of work is a dossier with one question: "What must remain visible before this approval?" The service does not begin by assuming that someone is lying. It distinguishes a documented contradiction, an insufficiently supported conclusion, relevant information missing from a summary, and simple lack of access to evidence.

Claim to Check	Useful Check	Outcome Purchased
“The pilot is production-ready.”	Which production conditions were tested, and which were excluded?	Acceptance conditions to add or retain.
“Customers prefer option A.”	Which participants, questions, and responses support the conclusion?	The limits of the segment to which the recommendation applies.
“The delay is the supplier’s responsibility.”	Which documented dependencies and deadlines applied to both parties?	A shared timeline and uncertainty about attribution.
“The problem has been solved.”	What evidence exists after the intervention, and over what period?	The difference between a remedy being implemented and its outcome being verified.

Checking the Past and Examining Consequences

The product has two tasks that must not be confused. The first compares a claim with the available evidence. The second examines what might follow from accepting a proposal: dependencies, transferred costs, eliminated options, accumulating obligations, or effects on absent participants. This second task is scenario analysis, not a factual finding about the future.

For example, a contract may be coherent yet leave the customer obliged to provide data within a period the customer cannot control. The report can state a condition: if access is not obtained, the technical stage may stall while payments continue. The commercial question follows: who assumes that dependency, and what happens to the schedule? The scenario identifies its assumptions and uncertainty; it does not claim to have predicted the incident.

This function takes the product beyond proofreading. It checks both what disappeared from the representation of a situation and which relevant consequences have not yet been discussed. Scenarios are labeled separately and are not used to accuse either party of deliberately hiding a risk.

The Standard Deliverable

The customer receives a short summary and an evidence register. The summary contains no more than five priority observations, not every discrepancy detected. The register preserves the other findings and the limits of the analysis, so editorial filtering does not itself become a convenient omission.

Each observation follows the same structure: the exact claim, the relevant source, the difference identified, the possible consequence, the uncertainty, and the recommended question or change. Alternative wording retains useful commercial meaning without hiding conditions. The customer also sees what would overturn the observation: an additional test, an approval, a missing document, or a contextual explanation.

The report explicitly lists the corpus consulted, the period covered, and what was not examined. “We did not find the evidence in the documents received” is not replaced with “the evidence does not exist.” A document version and an observation identifier make it possible to track corrections.

From Review to Continuous Monitoring

The product has four distinct modes. **One-off review** checks a dossier before a decision. **Flow monitoring** periodically compares the same commitments with updates. **Bilateral Safe** gives two parties to a project a shared register and rules for challenge. **The API** lets other applications request checks and display the observations in their own product.

A Safe is a rule-governed workspace, not an escrow service, a court, or a guarantee of safety. At first, documents can be uploaded manually. Connectors are added only when several customers request the same integration. Continuous monitoring means tracking authorized updates, not having permanent access to every company conversation.

The individual view, called here a **private mirror**, helps one party correct its report before distribution. It does not grant the right to conceal a material finding that the bilateral mandate requires to be disclosed. The shared report retains the correction history and no longer presents a resolved issue as current.

Who Controls the Observations

The rules are agreed before a dispute arises. Each party may submit evidence, challenge the reasoning, and request an independent review. Neither party can buy the right to remove a correct finding merely because it is inconvenient. Joint payment, payment by one party, and the reviewer's independence are disclosed separately.

In a unilateral review, the product can analyze only materials the client may legitimately provide. It does not claim to represent the absent party as well. In a bilateral Safe, report distribution follows the agreed mandate. A company's refusal to participate is not evidence of dishonesty.

Equal rules do not imply equal blame. A report may find that every material discrepancy originates in the documents of the same party. The aim is not to balance criticism artificially, but to apply the same evidentiary requirement.

3. Choosing the Entry Market

The Commercial Filter

An attractive initial market has five characteristics: a decision with identifiable stakes; accessible documents; a buyer who can authorize a modest expense; recurring analysis; and product errors that can be challenged and corrected without disproportionate consequences. An abstract need for “more truth” is not a sufficient commercial criterion.

The ranking below favors the ability to sell and deliver quickly. It does not equate sector size with the available market. A larger niche may be a weaker starting choice if it requires access to sensitive systems, accreditation, months of integration, or simultaneous acceptance by many parties.

Rank	Niche	Reason to Buy	Main Obstacle
1	AI/software projects: pilot, acceptance, expansion	Turning a promise into a verifiable commitment.	Access to tests and sufficiently clear acceptance definitions.
2	Research and analysis agencies	Protecting the quality of conclusions delivered to clients.	Coding context and relevance, not only citations.
3	API for products that generate summaries	A fidelity-checking function integrated into the product.	Low price per check and strong technical competition.
4	Technical review before investments or acquisitions	Identifying material claims that lack sufficient support.	Liability and need for experts; episodic purchasing.
5	Commercial claims about B2B products	Linking promises to evidence before publication.	It may be seen as slowing sales.
6	Client–supplier project portfolios	A timeline and shared view of progress.	Requires integration, authorization, and conflict management.
7	Reporting to boards and investors	Visibility of qualifications lost between reporting levels.	The buyer may also be the author of the report under review.
8	Funding applications and project reports	Consistency among objectives, achievements, and evidence.	Fragmented budgets and institution-specific requirements.
9	Scientific publications and editorial review	Fidelity of summaries and interpretation of results.	Low budget per document; barriers to adoption.
10	General employee monitoring	Management interest in unreported problems.	High risk of surveillance and disciplinary use.
11	Political communication and public administration	Review of public claims with collective consequences.	Polarization, contested mandate, difficult monetization.

Rank	Niche	Reason to Buy	Main Obstacle
12	Universal personal assistant	An accessible review of everyday texts.	Low willingness to pay and free competition.

The first two niches can share infrastructure, but require different criteria and evaluators. A very small team should not launch them at the same time. Choose the one with real access to buyers and documents, then test the alternative if the first does not lead to repeat purchases.

The Wrong Client Costs More Than No Client

Requests to label people liars, build hidden dossiers on employees, or guarantee a conclusion favorable to the buyer are excluded from the outset. Likewise, a project whose essential documents cannot be examined must not be sold as “complete monitoring.” A limited analysis may be sold, but its limit must appear in the offer and report.

A suitable buyer accepts that a finding may be unfavorable to their own organization. They need not share a philosophy of transparency; it is enough to prefer a clear commitment over an expensive dispute or fragile report. This is the concrete form of trust for which payment should be tested.

4. The Primary Market: From AI Pilot to Contract

Client Profile

The proposed initial client is an AI or software services firm with roughly 10–249 employees, several parallel projects, and recurring acceptance or expansion decisions. This range is a commercial filter, not a technical limit. Smaller firms may buy one-off dossiers; very large organizations may have budgets but slower procurement and security processes.

Look for projects where the demonstration differs from contracted use: another dataset, a wider user population, different security requirements, incomplete integrations, or reported performance that omits necessary costs and human intervention. The offer does not repeat every technical test. It checks which conclusions the available tests support and which conditions must appear in the agreement.

An eligible request might sound like this: “Next week the client must decide whether to expand the pilot. We have the proposal, results, and issue list. We want to know what needs clarification before we promise production.” The project may be worth tens or hundreds of thousands of euros, but that does not automatically imply a budget for Anti-Smoothing. That budget must be verified separately.

The Real Buying Committee

Role	What They Want	Appropriate Message
CEO / founder	Credible contracts, manageable commercial risk, protection of reputation.	“Make the offer easier to approve without promising more than you can demonstrate.”
Delivery director	Clear acceptance criteria and fewer disputes about progress.	“We preserve the link among promises, conditions, and delivery evidence.”
Technical director	Prevent the limits of tests from becoming commercial certainties.	“We distinguish what was implemented from what was verified.”
Commercial lead	Avoid losing the deal in an endless exchange of clarifications.	“A trust dossier for questions that block approval.”
Supplier’s client	Know what they are buying and what depends on their own contribution.	“See your own obligations as well as the supplier’s.”
Security / data protection	Limit access to and exposure of documents.	“Bounded corpus, configured retention, disclosed providers, and auditable access.”

The strongest internal champion is often the delivery lead, who knows the difference between the offer and the project’s reality. The CEO matters when the product protects a commercial relationship or a repeatable offer. Every dossier need not begin with a direct sale to the CEO.

The First Offer, Without Heavy Integration

The launch package reviews one decision, no more than 20 priority claims, and an agreed corpus. The supplier sends the proposal, success criteria, test results, progress report, and open issues. The client indicates which approval is coming and which questions might change it.

The deliverable is a decision dossier: no more than five important findings, an evidence register, questions for both parties, and alternative wording. A clarification meeting resolves the reviewer's misinterpretations and identifies the additional evidence needed. The service does not promise project approval or certify that the application is safe.

If the project continues, the same register can be updated after each phase. That is the rationale for a subscription: obligations and evidence change. A client with just one decision a year remains a one-off review client; they should not be forced into an unnecessary subscription.

The Benefit for Supplier and Buyer

The supplier can voluntarily disclose the limits of its demonstration before they emerge in a dispute. The buyer can accept a useful but conditional project rather than oscillate between complete trust and deadlock. Sometimes the important finding is that the limitation can be resolved through the client's contribution: better data, system access, or a delayed approval.

Value does not require eliminating risk. A transaction may become acceptable precisely because risk is allocated explicitly and the next phase is smaller. Anti-Smoothing must also allow a positive conclusion: "The evidence is sufficient for this phase, subject to these conditions," rather than producing objections regardless of the content.

How to Lose This Market

The product will be rejected if it slows approval with trivial findings, requires more work than an internal review, or looks like a buyer's weapon against the supplier. It will also fail if sold as a universal evaluator that cannot interpret the project's logs, metrics, and technical conventions.

The commercial remedy is initial specialization: one or two project families, shared criteria, short reports, and expert escalation for material interpretations. A dossier with weak documentation may first need evidence organization, a separately charged service; that work must not be hidden in the AI model's cost.

5. The Second Market: Research and Analysis Reports

The Offer: Conclusions That Survive a Return to Sources

A research agency sells conclusions, not merely documents. For Anti-Smoothing, the opportunity is to check the passage from interviews, notes, responses, or results to the recommendation delivered to the client. The product examines whether the synthesis preserved sample limitations, relevant minority views, conditions attached to claims, and the distinction between observation and interpretation.

A suitable initial client produces recurring reports, has someone responsible for methodology, and serves clients for whom a recommendation could change a product, investment, or strategy. A firm that delivers only transcription or mechanical aggregation probably gains less. Very small agencies can buy a review on delivery without subscribing.

Here the product should not turn every summary into a copy of the source. The question is whether what was removed would change the conclusion for the report's audience. An isolated caveat may be unimportant; it may also be the only signal of a severe risk. Relevance does not follow solely from the number of mentions.

Buyer, timing, and documents

The decision-maker is the founder, research director, or quality lead. The users are the researchers and report editors. The right moment is before an important study is delivered or when the agency introduces AI summarization into an existing workflow. The commercial message is: **“Increase delivery capacity without losing the caveats and nuances for which the client pays for research.”**

The file includes the research question, relevant protocol, authorized sources, synthesis, and recommendations. Quantitative results require denominators, definitions, and the extracts needed for verification; a language model must not be used in place of statistical calculation. For qualitative material, the product preserves the path from a conclusion to the passages that support or limit it.

The review does not assert that the source is the complete truth. An interview may be inaccurate, and a sample may be unsuitable. The fidelity of the synthesis to the material received and the validity of the research in relation to the world are distinct. Only the latter requires a broader methodological mandate and a corresponding offer.

What can become a subscription

A package can cover four defined deliveries or updates per month. The workflow is attractive if the same indicators, report structure, and anonymization rules recur. The initial setup can be reused, and the team can see whether certain omissions recur in the process, without the product generating scores about employees' character.

An agency can give its client a summary of the review and access to the relevant findings without exposing all the raw materials. This distribution must be authorized and does not automatically create a new subscription. The invited client becomes a buyer only if it later has its own workflow it wants to check.

The competition is real

Tools such as Dovetail allow people to work with research materials and link documents to evidence. This traceability is a valuable feature, not an open commercial space. Anti-Smoothing must demonstrate the additional value of checking what was lost between sources and conclusion; alternatively, it could become a component integrated into such a workflow. [8]

The decisive test is a comparison with a researcher using current tools on the same time budget. If the new service identifies only misquoted passages that are already easy to detect, differentiation is insufficient. If it finds a condition or counterexample that changes the recommendation and can explain why, it makes a distinct commercial contribution.

Entry limits

I would not start by evaluating medical conclusions or promising complete scientific validation. B2B market research, user experience, and commercial analysis reports with bounded sources are better suited to launch. Files containing sensitive data require a suitable processing workflow and appropriate reviewers before they are accepted.

Members of a future network can bring expertise in different sectors or languages. Their valuable contribution is the ability to assess materiality in context, not the right to replace evidence with a majority opinion.

6. Extensions: API, technical review, and portfolios

An API for applications that produce summaries

The API sells a structured check: sources, the text to assess, the purpose of the communication, and relevance rules enter the service; localized observations, limitations, and suggestions for correction come out of it. The buyer is a software company that already has users, not an end client to whom every technical component must be explained.

The appropriate profile is a provider of automated reports, research summaries, project documentation, or B2B relationship assistants. The decision-maker is the product or technical director; the internal evaluator is the quality lead. The reason to buy must be a defect observed in the company's own product, not a generic wish to display another AI feature.

Integration can include assessment before publication, visible warnings in the editor, and a check after correction. Not every result requires human review, but the interface must show when an observation is automated. The purchasing application cannot turn an API response into a certificate of truth.

Competition is more intense than for the specialized service. Patronus offers evaluators for multiple dimensions of responses, Galileo combines evaluation with observability, and Langfuse allows customized scores and evaluators. Anti-Smoothing must be compared with these alternatives and with an internally built evaluator, not only with the absence of any checking. [9–11]

The condition for launching the API: at least two paying partners with recurring cases who accept a shared schema and can measure the effect on their product. Without them, development of a general

platform would mainly finance hypothetical integration. The possible differentiation lies in the test set and relevance policy, not merely in calling another model.

Technical review for investments and acquisitions

An investor or technology buyer may want a limited number of claims checked: performance, implementation stage, dependencies, rights over components, or limits of testing. The buyer may pay more per file than an operational team, but frequency is lower and interpretations can have important consequences.

The offer must include a domain expert and be distinguished from a complete legal, financial, or technical analysis. The product supplies the trail between claim and evidence; it does not estimate the company's value on its own or automatically recommend an investment. A commercial range to explore would be EUR 3,000–10,000 for a specialized file, depending on volume and expertise, with costs negotiated separately.

This niche is better suited to a specialized operator or distribution partner than to the standard launch offer. A higher price must not be confused with better economics: expert preparation, liability, and the buying cycle can consume the margin.

Project portfolios and internal reporting

After successful checks on individual projects, an organization may request a view across several collaborations. The product can track changes in obligations, risks that disappear from reports, and differences between the executive summary and documented situations. The operations director or project office becomes the relevant buyer.

The extension should operate at the level of workflows and projects, not by creating a score for people's honesty. Access to a portfolio does not imply access to every participant's private messages.

Executive reports must also retain the problems for which leadership is responsible; otherwise the product becomes a machine for shifting blame downward.

This market better justifies a bilateral or organizational Safe, but requires permission management, an access log, and a clear appeal mechanism. It is not simply a multiplication of the price of a one-off report.

What must not be promised in the first stage

The service does not sell intent detection, replacement of arbiters, unlimited behavior monitoring, or universal certification of collaboration. It does not guarantee that a report contains no omissions. It does not aim to maximize the number of alerts: a correct system may go for weeks without a single material finding.

The expansion market should be decided from delivery data. If a client primarily needs document organization, that may be a profitable ancillary activity, but it does not prove the Anti-Smoothing thesis. If a client wants only commercial rewording, the service becomes a writing tool. Both may exist, but their revenue must be separated when evaluating the business.

7. Competition, positioning, and competitive advantage

What the client buys in the product's absence

The main alternative is not always a competing startup. It may be a director who reads the file personally, a consultant, a general AI tool, a checklist, or acceptance of the risk. The price of Anti-Smoothing must be compared with this actual behavior, including the option of doing nothing.

Alternative	Documented function or role	Anti-Smoothing's positioning
Internal human review	Contextual knowledge and decision-making authority.	Time savings and better coverage; the person remains the benchmark and part of the procedure.
General AI assistant	On-demand comparison and drafting.	Bounded corpus, tests, stable evidence, tracking, and appeals. The advantage must be demonstrated.
Luminance	Contract analysis and negotiation. [7]	Comparison of commitments with later evidence, not replacement of the entire contractual workflow.
Dovetail	Work with research and evidence-linked documents. [8]	Checking for material losses between the material and the conclusion; possible integration.
Patronus / Galileo	Evaluators, monitoring, and AI quality tools. [9,10]	Fidelity and relevance policies adapted to the decision; partly direct competition.
Langfuse	Configurable evaluations and scores in AI workflows. [11]	An integrable specialized engine, not a duplication of general observability.

The capabilities above come from vendor documentation, not from a comparative benchmark conducted for this book. There is no evidence here that Anti-Smoothing outperforms the products mentioned. This must be tested on the exact task and at comparable costs.

Recommended positioning

The category formulation is **“independent fidelity checking for decisions and collaborations”**. In initial sales, an even more concrete formulation is used: “review of conditions and evidence before accepting an AI pilot.” Anti-Smoothing may become the umbrella brand; the first buyer need not adopt the terminology before seeing the result.

The message should not accuse organizations of lying. A manager who buys the product should not have to announce that their team is under suspicion. The legitimate motivation is the quality of commitments and the ability to collaborate with fewer incompatible interpretations.

Positive differentiation matters: the product can explain how to formulate a proposal that preserves its conditions while remaining persuasive. It does more than optimize defect detection; it contributes to a usable agreement. Its effect on the decision must be measured, not replaced with the satisfaction of producing a harsh report.

What may become hard to copy

A set of prompts can be copied. Harder to reproduce would be the combination of a legitimately obtained evaluation corpus, tested sector-specific criteria, reporting accepted by both parties, a history of fairly resolved appeals, and a network of competent operators. These assets are formed through delivery, not through a brand declaration.

The shared corpus must not be a clandestine collection of clients' contracts and conversations. It may include synthetic cases, public cases, and authorized examples with clear rights. Performance metadata may be useful without exposing documents. A competitive advantage built on unauthorized processing would be a liability, not an asset.

Procedural independence can differentiate the service in sensitive collaborations. It does not follow automatically from the number of members or from using several models. It is demonstrated through declared conflicts, compensation independent of the verdict, the inability to suppress findings, and genuine appeals.

What happens if models get much better

If automated fidelity assessment becomes a cheap and common feature, the technical engine's margin may fall. The startup remains viable only if it offers something for which the client still pays: integration into a process, responsibility for review, specialization, or a report the counterparty accepts.

If these things, too, become easy to provide internally, the strategy must change. The first operator in a category has no permanent right to rent. Licensing, operation of specialized workflows, and the shared assets of a consortium are adaptation options, not guarantees against competition.

8. Customer value and evidence that it is worth paying for

Four categories of value

Operational value means fewer hours spent locating evidence, fewer rounds of clarification, and less rework. **Commercial value** means an agreement that is easier to justify, an approved stage, or a retained client. **Governance value** means preserving responsibilities and a path for appeal. **Epistemic value** means that decision-makers correctly understand the limitations.

The first two may sometimes have a financial expression. The others must also be assessed directly, without forcing a conversion into euros. Being able to correct a misinterpretation or see why a conclusion is limited has value, but does not by itself justify any price.

Value tracked	Proposed measurement	Mistake to avoid
Review time	Total hours, including verification of alerts and correction of the report.	Counting the time saved by AI while ignoring the additional review.
Faster decision	Time from completed file to decision; compared with similar cases.	Attributing every delay or acceleration to the product.
Less rework	Hours and costs of changes linked to detectable misunderstandings.	Treating every project change as an avoidable loss.
Clearer commitment	Number of material conditions explicitly accepted by both parties.	Confusing longer documentation with a better agreement.
Better fidelity	Proportion of material differences identified and corrected, on a benchmark set.	Counting alerts without verifying their accuracy.
Procedural trust	Acceptance of the rules and appeals, including when the report is unfavorable.	Using buyer satisfaction as proof of neutrality.

The subscription's economic threshold

At EUR 1,290 per month, saving 12 hours valued at EUR 70 per hour produces EUR 840 in gross value: that alone does not justify the price. Saving 24 hours produces EUR 1,680; the difference from the subscription is EUR 390 before other costs. These examples show how easily the productivity argument can be overstated.

A facilitated commercial decision may yield more, but measurement must use incremental margin, not the full value of the contract. If a EUR 100,000 project would have been signed anyway, the product did not “create EUR 100,000.” One might instead measure time saved, an additional stage, or reduced rework, without double counting.

Avoided risks must not be valued by multiplying an imaginary disaster by an invented probability. Scenarios can be developed with the client, but their probabilities remain assumptions. Commercial reporting separates observed savings, plausibly attributed benefits, and unconfirmed possibilities.

Technical evaluation needed before scaling

A useful test includes documents with material differences, documents with legitimate simplifications, and files with incomplete sources. Findings are assessed by specialists who do not know which system produced them. The product is compared with current review and a general assistant at similar budgets.

Measure both the precision of important alerts and the proportion of important problems found. A system that is silent almost all the time may appear precise while offering useless coverage. A system that sees problems everywhere may find many real cases but be abandoned because of the noise.

Proposed thresholds for a pilot, to be negotiated before evaluation: at least 90% of alerts classified as material should be confirmed by reviewers; at least 70% of material differences should be detected in a bounded set; no invented references in reviewed reports; and every severe consequence should be checked by a person. These are acceptance criteria, not existing performance or guarantees in new domains.

Cases are split between development and testing, and results are reported by file type, language, and length. A few dozen projects can test usefulness and cost, not the rate of rare incidents. The uncertainty of estimates and the number of cases must remain in reports to investors.

From a finding to collaboration

An alert is useful only if it can change an action. The product should track whether it was accepted, corrected, contested, or left open, and why. A disagreement sometimes legitimately persists because the parties have different interests. Anti-Smoothing must not convert every divergence into a technical error.

Success may be a transaction completed on better terms, but also a transaction abandoned in time. To avoid the wrong incentives, compensation does not depend on signing the agreement or on a favorable verdict. The service's commercial value is the possibility of a better-founded decision, not an obligation that every project continue.

9. Packages, prices, and commercial limits

Price should be tied to work and the decision

The recommended billing unit is the file or project workflow, not the person monitored or the number of problems found. Pricing per alert would reward noise. Pricing per employee would push the product toward undifferentiated organizational monitoring. An unlimited subscription would hide analysis and appeal costs that are hard to control.

For comparability, a **standard batch** means no more than 25,000 words in the selected sources, a text of up to 3,000 words to be checked, and at most 20 priority claims. The limits are proposed for experimentation; they do not represent a model's maximum capacity. The selection of claims and sources is documented. The volume limit does not permit an extract to be presented as a complete project review.

Offer	Proposed price	Content and limit	Suitable client
One-off review	EUR 1,500 / file	One batch, six hours of expert time, one clarification, and the decision report.	An imminent decision, without a recurring need yet.
Team	EUR 1,290 / month	Four batches, four hours of human review, and one hour of support in total.	A team with recurring documents and a stable format.
Bilateral Safe	EUR 2,900 / month	Two active projects, eight batches, eight hours of review, and two hours of support.	Client–supplier relationships with updates and a shared report.
Assisted software	EUR 290 / month	Eight automated batches; no report signed by an independent reviewer.	A team that checks the findings itself. Available later.
API	Minimum EUR 490 / month	Up to 200 short comparisons; excess usage is charged separately.	A software provider with an integrated workflow. Available later.
Dedicated installation	EUR 6,000–15,000 initially; EUR 1,500–4,000 / month	Agreed configuration, versions, and support; computing resources and review are quoted explicitly.	An organization with justified volume and control requirements.

A short API comparison would cover at most 5,000 source words and 1,000 words to be checked. Reanalyses, greater lengths, and special requirements are counted. The API price does not include human intervention and is not directly comparable with a batch in the Team package.

Why a one-off review includes more human hours

The first file requires understanding the context, configuring the policy, and checking the interpretation. The subscription assumes that this configuration can be reused across a stable workflow. If every update has an entirely new domain, sources, and criteria, the client does not qualify for the same subscription economics.

Four monthly hours of review do not mean an expert reads every possible document in full. The expert examines priority claims and selected findings, checks relevant citations, and approves the report within the stated limits. If this cannot credibly be done within the time included, the product narrows the agreed scope or sells additional work. It does not publish a report that appears to provide exhaustive coverage.

Additional work is authorized before execution: for example, another expert day, a second reviewer, or a larger corpus. Disputes caused by operator errors must not automatically become hours billed to the client. The contract distinguishes correction of one's own mistakes from a legitimate expansion of the mandate.

How to test the price

The initial price is presented together with a concrete deliverable and a complete example. One does not start by asking, “how much would you pay for transparency?” Instead, ask for an order or a paid pilot on a real file. Discounts, if any, are tied to a stated benefit for the experiment and are not counted as evidence for the full price.

After the first deliveries, test whether the client wants the same procedure for the next decision and how often. Offers of EUR 990, 1,290, and 1,690 for equivalent scopes can be compared among comparable groups, without a hidden change in the service. In a small sample, these results are commercial signals, not a precise demand curve.

Who pays in a Safe

A bilateral project may be paid for by one party, split between the parties, or included in the project budget. The choice is disclosed. The same space does not become two subscriptions simply because it has two participants. The guest's access to the report and appeals must work without purchasing a second package.

Payment does not confer control over the verdict. Instead, the client controls the initial mandate, volume, and right to stop future contract periods. Ending the subscription must not retroactively erase a shared finding or the right to export permitted documents and responses.

Local installation is a separate product

Running locally or in a dedicated environment may meet confidentiality requirements, but adds administration, updates, testing, and support. It must not be offered for free as a sales argument. “Local” does not mean that every model runs acceptably on any computer, nor that internal access risks disappear.

At launch, a dedicated offer is accepted only if revenue covers the cost difference and the configuration can be reused. A wholly bespoke implementation for the first client could turn a product company into an integrator with no resources for the rest of the market.

10. Customer access and promotion

A message for an approaching decision

The main launch message is: **“Before you approve the next stage, we check what was lost between the evidence and the conclusion on which you are about to rely.”** For the supplier, the same offer is expressed positively: “Present a proposal that can be believed without hiding its limits.”

The website should include a complete example with synthetic sources, a report, and an accepted appeal. A screen showing an honesty score is not a demonstration. The buyer must see which documents to send, what they will receive, how long it takes after the complete file arrives, and who is responsible for the review.

Terms such as “lie detector,” “the organization's truth,” or “total elimination of risk” should be avoided. They promise more than the product can demonstrate and may turn promotion into an example of the very problem it claims to solve.

Channels in the recommended order

Channel	Entry offer	Why it may work	What is measured
Direct contact with AI/software companies	Review of a pilot approaching acceptance.	Identifiable decision and documents; a concrete discussion.	Paid orders, not polite replies.
Delivery consultants and technical evaluators	A standard report integrated into an existing mandate.	The partner has trust and access to the buyer.	Active clients brought in and margin after the partner's compensation.
Research agencies	Review before an important report is delivered.	The user can immediately check whether the observations are relevant.	Repeat purchase at the next delivery.
Professional workshops	A demonstration dossier, analyzed and challenged live.	The product is visible, not merely described.	Qualified participants who bring a real dossier.
Software partners	A limited, paid integration addressing a known defect.	Existing distribution and potential repeat volume.	Usage, cost per case, and effect on quality.
Bilateral referral	Free Safe access for the counterparty.	The new participant sees the product in a real relationship.	Organizations that later buy for their own workflow.

For research, the MRS and ESOMAR directories offer starting points for identifying firms and specializations. A company’s presence in a directory does not prove interest in the product; the fit of each account must be checked. [17,18]

Broad advertising should be delayed until the offer and repeat purchasing are clear. A new term such as Anti-Smoothing may attract curiosity without purchase intent. Public materials should answer familiar situations: the limits of a pilot, the difference between results and promises, and a report’s fidelity to its interviews.

Qualifying an account before making an offer

An account is qualified if a decision is due in the coming weeks, someone is responsible, a set of documents is accessible, and the organization is willing to accept unfavorable findings. Check separately who can approve the expenditure and who can authorize sharing the materials. An enthusiastic internal advocate replaces neither authority.

The first discussion asks for an example of a recent misunderstanding, the current review method, and the approximate cost of clarifications. It does not ask for an inventory of every organizational problem. If there is no imminent case, the contact can be kept for later; it does not automatically become a free pilot.

A prospecting register should include the niche, contact person, trigger, possible dossier, data access, budget, and next step. The number of addresses collected is not a market indicator. Nor does a CEO who likes the idea but will not allow a paid test validate the offer.

Sales messages to test

To an AI company founder: “Do you have a pilot that is about to be expanded? We review the proposal and results, identify conditions that must remain visible, and prepare an acceptance dossier for both parties. The first review has a fixed scope and price.”

To a research director: “We compare the report’s conclusions with the material that supports them. We look not only for incorrect quotations, but also for qualifications or segments that could change the recommendation. Your team may challenge each observation before closure.”

To a software product owner: “Do you have cases where the summary is fluent and factually plausible but loses an important condition? We can test a structured review on your cases, comparing it with your current evaluator, without migrating the entire infrastructure.”

These texts are communication hypotheses. Keep only messages that bring qualified discussions and orders, not those that receive the most social reactions.

Obstacles and credible responses

“We can do this with a general-purpose model” is a legitimate objection. The response is a comparative test, not a claim of architectural superiority. “We do not want to expose documents” calls for an appropriate processing offer or declining the case, not vague assurances. “It will damage the relationship with the supplier” calls for a balanced report and a right of reply, not a promise that nobody will be disturbed.

“We do not want another report” may mean the deliverable should be integrated into the existing approval. Observations can be exported into a decision register or the current document. The product must reduce relevant work, not force the customer to maintain a new administrative ceremony.

Growth through counterparties

A customer can invite a partner into the same Safe. The partner sees the sources, limits, and correction method. If it later has a project of its own, it may buy a package. This is a possible propagation mechanism, but it should not be assumed to work automatically.

For example, 20 customers each inviting three organizations would generate 60 raw invitations, not 60 new customers. After deduplication, 45 might remain; if 15 participate actively and three

buy, the result is three new customers. These numbers illustrate a calculation. The commercial model must be fed with observed invitations, activations, and purchases separately.

The network is stronger if participants accept the report even when it disadvantages them. If invitations are perceived as sales pressure or as an instrument of control by the dominant partner, propagation may provoke rejection. Free access to challenges and explicit rules are conditions of distribution, not merely ethical principles.

11. Market size: benchmarks and limits

What can be estimated before the first sales

There is no statistical category called “Anti-Smoothing subscriptions.” A defensible estimate starts with observable populations of organizations, applies eligibility filters, and shows sensitivity to those filters and to price. The result is a hypothetical revenue opportunity, not measured demand.

The UK benchmarks below are used because they define two relevant segments. They are not a mandatory recommendation to launch in the United Kingdom. The initial market may be another geography if commercial access and language capacity are better; in that case, rebuild the account list and calculation rather than mechanically transferring the percentage.

The AI/software segment

The DSIT study of the UK AI sector in 2024, published on 3 September 2025, identifies 896 small firms and 532 medium-sized firms: 1,428 in total. The population includes diverse AI activities, not just eligible generative application or service providers. This is a 2024 benchmark, not a 2026 census. [2]

At the Team subscription price of EUR 1,290 per month, annual spending is EUR 15,480. Applying filters of 20%, 35%, and 50% gives the following scenarios. Organization counts are rounded; the percentages do not come from a demand survey.

Eligibility scenario	Approximate organizations	Annual revenue if all bought a package
20% of benchmark	286	EUR 4.43 million
35% of benchmark	500	EUR 7.74 million
50% of benchmark	714	EUR 11.05 million

Eligibility must be checked against project type, dossier frequency, budget, and access to evidence. Even the 20% scenario is not “conservative” in any demonstrated sense; it may be too optimistic. The paying market may be much smaller if firms prefer one-off reviews or internal processes.

The research and analysis segment

MRS estimates at least 4,000 UK research, insight, and analysis enterprises, using an older scope and data, including the 2022 register. This benchmark must not be presented as a new count for 2026. A substantial share of the firms is very small, which is why the eligibility filters below are narrower. [3]

Eligibility scenario	Organizations	Annual revenue at EUR 15,480 per organization
5% of 4,000	200	EUR 3.10 million
10% of 4,000	400	EUR 6.19 million
15% of 4,000	600	EUR 9.29 million

The two tables are not automatically additive. Some research firms may also be counted in the AI sector; the same organization may have one quality budget for several workflows. The real market requires deduplication and verification of the number of distinct subscriptions, not summing sector labels.

European expansion envelope

Eurostat reports approximately 251,000 medium-sized and 55,000 large enterprises in the EU business economy for 2024, based on preliminary data published in December 2025: about 306,000 in total. This universe is far broader than the product’s customer base. [4]

If only 1%, 3%, or 5% had an eligible workflow and bought an annual subscription of EUR 15,480, the results would be approximately EUR 47.37, 142.11, or 236.84 million. This is a **sensitivity exercise for expansion**, not the startup's addressable market. It includes unsuitable sectors, organizations with internal solutions, and entities that may belong to the same purchasing group.

We do not multiply this universe by an AI adoption rate from a survey with different coverage. We do not add API and operator revenue on top of the same subscriptions without verifying the transactions. Nor do we use the value of reviewed contracts as the service's potential revenue.

How much an individual startup can reach

At the Team price, 30 subscriptions represent EUR 464,400 in annual recurring revenue; 100 represent EUR 1.548 million; 300 represent EUR 4.644 million. This is scale arithmetic, not forecasting. At four monthly review hours per customer, 300 customers require 1,200 productive expert hours per month, before one-off reviews and additional quality control.

A startup can become a good company without becoming a venture-capital investment. Greater potential requires distribution through partners, reusable processes, and a larger share of revenue that does not rise proportionally with expert hours. An API can help, but it has a different price, different competition, and different sales costs.

The attainable market in the first year

The working target should not be a percentage of the European market. It should be an account list, a number of qualified conversations, and delivery capacity. The financial scenario in the

next chapter ends the year with 21 subscriptions and 53 one-off dossiers sold during the year. Those dossiers do not necessarily represent 53 unique organizations.

The model assumes 24 new subscriptions and three losses. It does not derive that performance from a list of 100 contacts. The sales channel must demonstrate that it can produce the required volume; otherwise, fixed spending is deferred and the scenario recalculated.

12. Startup economics and launch financing

The real cost of a subscription

The economics are built from the bottom up. For the Team package, the scenario assumes four expert hours at EUR 70 per hour, one support hour at EUR 50, and separate costs for models, infrastructure, and remediation. These figures must be replaced with costs measured in the pilot. They are not the rates of any particular AI provider.

Monthly Team component	Assumed cost
Models, search, and reanalysis	EUR 60
Allocated hosting, storage, and security	EUR 45
Human review: 4 × EUR 70	EUR 280
Support: 1 × EUR 50	EUR 50
Reserve for remediation and incidents	EUR 35
Total direct cost	**EUR 470**
Revenue	**EUR 1,290**
Contribution before fixed costs	**EUR 820 / 63.6%**

The contribution margin is not net profit. It excludes general development, sales, management, taxes, and financing. A contract with special security requirements may have substantial additional costs. These must not be fictitiously spread across customers who do not yet exist.

For a one-off review, the scenario uses EUR 600 in direct cost against EUR 1,500 in revenue: six expert hours, coordination, processing, and a reserve. The contribution is EUR 900. For bilateral Safe, the illustrative cost is EUR 875 against EUR 2,900 in revenue, including eight review hours and two support hours. The Safe estimate is less certain because challenges between the parties may consume additional time.

The critical variable: human time

If a Team customer requires eight expert hours instead of four, the direct cost rises to EUR 750 and contribution falls to EUR 540, or 41.9%. Cheaper AI calls do not automatically offset this change. Measuring time per dossier is a management requirement, not an administrative detail.

At 100 productive review hours per month, an expert can cover approximately 25 Team customers under the four-hour assumption. Capacity falls to about 12 if eight hours are required. Internal meetings, training, and quality control come on top; not every contracted hour is assumed to be billable.

With EUR 12,500 in monthly fixed and commercial costs, approximately 16 Team subscriptions are needed to break even on their contribution alone. Five one-off dossiers in a month add EUR 4,500 in contribution under the scenario and lower the threshold to roughly ten subscriptions. This calculation is not a promise to sell five dossiers every month.

Acquisition cost and retention

At a total acquisition cost of EUR 3,000 per customer, payback from the Team contribution of EUR 820 would take about 3.7 months. At EUR 6,000 it would take about 7.3 months. These are threshold examples, not observed acquisition costs. The conservative calculation does not use the margin from a possible pilot to shorten the period.

Acquisition cost includes the founder's sales time, demonstrations, partners, and marketing. It is not calculated from the advertising budget alone. Lifetime value must not be estimated by arbitrarily assuming that a customer will stay for five years. Until enough cohorts exist, retention is reported directly, with the number of customers and their observed duration.

Twelve-month cash scenario

The model assumes 24 new subscriptions, three losses, and 53 one-off dossiers. New and lost subscriptions change billing halfway through the month; 50% of dossier payments arrive in the delivery month and 50% in the next month. Activating a customer costs EUR 200, with no separate revenue. Monthly fixed costs follow this schedule: EUR 5,000 per month for the first three months, EUR 8,000 for the next three, and EUR 11,000 for the last six.

The marketing budget is EUR 500, 1,000, and then 1,500 per month for the same intervals. Initial cost is EUR 8,000. Fixed costs include compensation for nonbillable activities; billable review is already included in direct costs, without double counting. The model excludes VAT, income tax, financing, and distributions to owners.

Month	Active (new / lost)	One-off dossiers	Invoiced revenue	Cumulative cash
1	0 (0/0)	2	3.000	-13.2
2	1 (1/0)	3	5.145	-16.5
3	2 (1/0)	3	6.435	-18.7
4	4 (2/0)	4	9.870	-22.0
5	6 (2/0)	4	12.450	-24.7
6	8 (2/0)	4	15.030	-28.1
7	10 (2/0)	5	19.110	-31.9
8	11 (2/1)	5	21.045	-35.7
9	14 (3/0)	5	23.625	-39.5
10	16 (3/1)	6	28.350	-43.2
11	19 (3/0)	6	31.575	-46.5
12	21 (3/1)	6	34.800	-49.8

Active subscriptions are counted at month-end; parentheses show new/lost. Amounts are in EUR. Cumulative cash starts at zero, before founder or investor contributions.

The resulting annual revenue is **EUR 210,435**, of which EUR 130,935 comes from subscriptions and EUR 79,500 from dossiers. Direct costs total EUR 84,305. After EUR 105,000 in fixed costs, EUR 13,500 in marketing, and EUR 8,000 in initial cost, the modeled pre-tax result is negative EUR 370. Annual cash flow is negative EUR 4,870; the EUR 4,500 difference is the receivable from dossiers in the final month.

At year-end there are 21 active subscriptions, with EUR 27,090 in monthly recurring revenue. Annualizing this level gives EUR 325,080, but it is not revenue earned in the first year. The maximum cumulative deficit is EUR 25,930 in month seven. A reserve of about EUR 35,000 would cover this scenario with a modest margin, not the adverse scenarios below.

Billable review hours total 724 for the year and reach 116 in the final month. Growth therefore requires available expert capacity; it cannot be attributed solely to automation. At first, this capacity can be contracted per dossier without hiring a large team in advance.

Model sensitivity

Scenario	Active subscriptions at year-end	Annual revenue	Maximum cash requirement, before reserve
Base	21	EUR 210,435	EUR 25,930
Eight-hour Team review, not four	21	EUR 210,435	EUR 38,140
Subscription reduced by 20%; dossiers unchanged	21	EUR 184,248	EUR 36,732
Slower acquisition and dossier sales, fixed costs unchanged	10	EUR 105,390	EUR 66,980

The final scenario reduces monthly new subscriptions to 70% and dossiers to 75% of the initial assumption, rounding down; it keeps losses and the fixed-cost schedule. It shows the risk of committing to expenses before validating sales. The realistic response is to defer costs, not assume that optimism will cover the gap.

What is financed, and in what order

The first stage funds paid dossiers, human review, and minimal infrastructure. The second funds automation of repeated tasks: extraction, versioning, comparison, and export. The third funds distribution through operators or an API, only after the workflow economics are known.

External capital becomes useful if repeatable demand exceeds current capacity, integration costs can be recovered, or expansion through partners already under contract is possible. It is not justified by a large market estimate alone. An investment should be tied to an uncertainty that money can reduce: delivery cost, conversion, retention, or counterparty acceptance of the report.

13. Startup or decentralized brand

Two distinct proposals for investors

The startup sells directly, owns or licenses the technology, and assumes delivery responsibility. It can work well in one language and one niche, with its own transparent protocol. It does not need a coalition to demonstrate the usefulness of a review.

The decentralized brand brings together independent operators who use shared assets and rules, take part in governance, and deliver in their own markets. The common promise is a verifiable procedure, not unanimity of opinion. Diversity may increase coverage and the capacity for challenge, but it does not automatically create credibility.

Dimension	Specialized startup	Decentralized brand
Initial speed	High: few decisions to coordinate.	Lower: rules and interests to align.
Commercial relationship	One provider, direct accountability.	Identified local operator; common procedure and separate appeal.
Specialization	Limited by the in-house team.	Can bring together complementary languages and skills.
Assets	Company technology and brand.	Licensed shared assets, plus operators' private assets.
Perceived independence	Must be demonstrated in every relationship.	Can be supported by separating the operator, rules, and appeal.
Economics	Customer revenue minus own costs.	Operator revenue and separate revenue for shared infrastructure.
Main risk	Dependence on founders and a single provider.	Capture by dominant members and uneven quality.

When a coalition is worth forming

A coalition is justified when operators bring something that cannot be obtained more simply through subcontracting: their own customers, local reputation, expertise that is hard to centralize, or the need for an appeal mechanism independent of the provider. It is not justified merely to split the bill for an AI model.

An initial group might have a technical operator, an AI project specialist, and a research operator. Each must make a verifiable commercial or operational contribution. Membership is not sold as a speculative investment in the brand's future. First there are deliveries and a shared need for procedures.

The startup may continue operating and supplying the infrastructure, but it must not claim that the brand is shared if it can unilaterally change the rules, extract all data, or prevent members from leaving. The legal form, licenses, and provider-switching mechanism must reflect the promise of independence.

Shared assets and private assets

The proposed shared assets are the observation schema, reporting standard, tests, relevance policies, training materials, brand, operator register, and appeal procedure. Shared software may be licensed openly or by contract; the choice must account for sustainable maintenance and funders' rights.

Customer documents, operators' commercial relationships, and expertise they have not contributed do not automatically become shared property. Reusing examples requires explicit rights and purposes. The coalition can share performance statistics and authorized cases without centralizing all raw data.

Ownership, hosting, and independence of evaluation are three different things. A consortium may use cloud infrastructure, and a local product may be controlled by one company. The brand must describe what is actually distributed, not use “decentralized” as a synonym for security or truth.

Governance that does not paralyze delivery

The operator makes operational decisions within its mandate. A technical group maintains the standard and tests. An appeal mechanism, separate from the challenged operator, checks material errors. Members control major rules, admission, use of the brand, and the common budget; they do not vote on every finding in every dossier.

A minority opinion may be retained if it has evidence and relevant consequences. A majority vote does not turn a claim into fact. Technical disagreement must be described through assumptions, sources, and limitations. Differences in values are declared, not hidden in an apparently objective score.

An operator that drafted a proposal cannot then present it as independently verified by itself. Either a clear internal-assistance label or review by an operator without that conflict is required. Payment for an appeal must not prevent correction of an obvious service error.

The economics of an operator and shared infrastructure

Suppose an operator has ten Team customers. Its monthly revenue is EUR 12,900, and its direct costs, at EUR 470 per customer, are EUR 4,700. One shared-funding assumption is a EUR 350 monthly fee plus 8% of eligible revenue: EUR 1,382 in total. The operator retains EUR 6,818 before its own fixed, commercial, and tax expenses.

The fee pays for the standard, maintenance, register, training, and common procedure. Computing costs included in the EUR 470 are delivery costs; they are not charged a second time under another name. An operator using different infrastructure rebuilds its model.

Economic level	Ten operators, each with ten Team customers
Annual revenue invoiced to customers by the entire network	EUR 1,548,000
Annual revenue of shared infrastructure	EUR 165,840
Illustrative common budget: EUR 120,000 fixed + EUR 1,800 per operator	EUR 138,000
Common surplus before taxes and other reserves	EUR 27,840

Shared infrastructure revenue is part of operator spending, not extra revenue to add on top of network sales. An investor in the technology company does not automatically own the members' entire turnover.

With only three operators of the same size, common revenue would be EUR 49,752 per year, insufficient for the same institutional budget. The network therefore begins with a limited set of assets and costs, then expands its functions after funding. An elaborate certification and appeals structure cannot be promised at zero cost.

The fees above are a scenario, not a tariff imposed on members. Independent operators set their own prices within legal and contractual obligations. The coalition must undergo legal review to avoid sharing sensitive commercial information or coordinating in an anticompetitive manner. [15]

How the snowball develops

An operator sells a review. The client brings the report into an actual relationship. The counterparty sees its usefulness and may purchase one for another project. A sector expert is brought in for a difficult

file and may become an operator if they have the capacity and clients required. Legitimately developed tests and procedures reduce the cost of the next delivery.

Healthy accumulation has three results: more commercial relationships, better procedures, and broader sector coverage. It need not depend on collecting all data or forcing counterparties to pay. Each operator must be able to justify their own activity economically even if the network does not double the following year.

Such a structure may become better known than an isolated startup because members use it in their own markets. It becomes respected only if its results, corrections, and sanctions are credible. A brand that tolerates favorable reports for payment consumes its central asset, however decentralized its ownership may be.

Exit, sanctions, and continuity

The client must be able to export the record and change operators without losing authorized evidence. A member may leave with assets they are entitled to use, but not with others' data or unlimited rights to the same brand. Conditions for any brand fork are set by contract.

Serious breaches may lead to suspension of the right to use the brand, an additional review, and notice to affected clients. The account of a sanction must respect confidentiality and the right of reply. Protecting the network's reputation does not justify concealing its own errors; applying the same discipline to operators is essential to the business model.

14. Delivery, security, and conditions of trust

The minimum architecture supporting the offer

The initial workflow has six stages: authorized intake of documents, extraction with references preserved, inventory of important claims, comparison with evidence, review of observations, and controlled distribution of the report. Versioning allows the check to be repeated after an update. A separate log records access, configuration, and review decisions.

The language model assists interpretation and proposes observations. Numerical checks, the existence of quotations, document identifiers, and certain consistency rules must be controlled by deterministic software. A citation that looks plausible is not accepted if the passage does not exist in the stated version.

The project does not begin by training a proprietary model. Available models are compared on the use cases, and the option to replace them is retained. Using two models may help, but their agreement is not independent evidence if they reproduce the same error or receive the same incomplete selection of sources.

Coverage is a product object

A model can process a great deal of text without using all the information evenly. The “Lost in the Middle” research documented sensitivity to the position of information in the models tested; it does not provide a universal error rate for products in 2026. The implementation implication is the need to test long documents, different orders, and relevant passages that are hard to retrieve. [6]

The initial source inventory must not be derived solely from the synthesis being checked. Otherwise, the product may seek only confirmations of what the text has already retained. A source-side

search is also needed: what conditions, exceptions, or responsibilities should have been examined for the decision agreed upon?

An extraction error, an inaccessible page, or a misread table is reported as a technical limitation. It does not become a finding about a party's conduct. Coverage assessment tracks priority documents and claims; it is not a "percentage of truth."

Documents are untrusted inputs

A document may contain instructions that attempt to change an agent's behavior. OWASP describes this risk as prompt injection and stresses the need for least privilege, validation, and additional controls. In Anti-Smoothing, sources are treated as data, not as authority to change the service's rules. [16]

The product must not automatically send documents to new recipients, execute commands, or modify commercial systems merely because the analyzed text requests it. Initial connectors are primarily read-only. Report distribution follows the access policy, not instructions found in documents.

Tests include hostile documents, contradictory sources, nonexistent quotations, changed names and roles of parties, and attempts to turn an interpretation into certainty. Updating the model requires rerunning relevant tests before using it in reports for which responsibility is assumed.

Data, labor, and legal use

For personal data in the EU, the design must clarify controller and processor roles, the legal basis and purpose of processing, data minimization, retention, security, and whether a data protection impact assessment is needed. A commercial contract alone does not

grant the right to use any data held by an organization. Decisions with significant effects based solely on automated processing require separate analysis. [12]

Employee monitoring requires separate attention to necessity, proportionality, transparency, and less intrusive alternatives. ICO guidance is a reference for the UK context, not an identical legal rule in every country. The launch product does not include individual behavior scores or automated disciplinary decisions. [13]

Classification under the AI Act depends on the intended use and on the role of the provider or deployer. A tool sold for documents may face different obligations if it is used to assess people at work. The name Anti-Smoothing or the label “assistant” does not settle its classification. The offering and use restrictions must be reviewed for each relevant configuration. [14]

These conditions are design and contracting requirements, not an exhaustive legal analysis. The precise rules must be checked in the jurisdictions of operation. “Guaranteed compliance” is not sold as an implicit subscription feature.

Liability and the verification label

A report states who produced it, who reviewed it, which policy and version were used, and how long the evidence remains valid. A public label may confirm that the procedure was applied to a particular case, not the general safety of the company. It must be possible to withdraw or correct the label.

The contract defines the service, response time, complaints procedure, and the parties’ responsibilities. Professional insurance and security must be budgeted for the activity; a disclaimer cannot be assumed to erase the consequences of an error. The NIST profile for generative AI can serve as a voluntary risk-management reference, not as product accreditation. [5]

Hidden costs that could change the model

Extracting information from poor documents, reconciling multiple versions, access rights, and appeals consume time. These costs must be recorded separately from report generation. If they dominate in a niche, the price, service scope, or chosen market must change.

An on-premises installation, a new language, and a new specialization each require testing. They are not commercially ready merely because the model can respond in that language. The coalition can share expertise and costs, but it cannot remove the need to verify each expansion.

15. Launch plan and investment criteria

The first 90 days

In the first month, the offering is built, not a universal platform. One niche and one document family are selected, two demonstration cases are prepared, and about 15 qualified buyers are interviewed. The goal is three paid orders with legitimate access to sources. These numbers are operational targets, not conversion forecasts.

In the second month, the service is delivered, and the time, cost, and usefulness of its findings are measured. Another engagement is sought from initial customers, alongside a few independent cases. Only automations that demonstrably reduce repetitive work are built. Incorrect reports are corrected; they are not conveniently excluded from evaluation.

In the third month, the subscription and a distribution partner are tested. A counterparty may be invited into a bounded Safe. If the operator cannot sustain quality or nobody buys again, expansion stops. The niche, price, or deliverable can change, but the failed assumption must be recorded.

Stage	Evidence required before the next investment
From concept to service	Paid orders for real cases, not just praise or letters of intent.
From service to subscription	Recurrence of the same need and actual use of the findings.
From subscription to scale	Stable delivery cost, verified quality, and recoverable acquisition cost.
From startup to partners	An operator can deliver without the founder's continual involvement.
From partners to a shared brand	Funded contributions, an upheld standard, and a functioning independent appeal.
From product to API	Two paying software buyers with integration and comparable evaluation.

The founder's dashboard

Paying organizations, cases sold, active subscriptions, and free invitees are tracked separately. Expert hours, total cost per case, the share of confirmed material alerts, important missed cases, and time to resolve appeals are reported. Recurring revenue is separated from services, onboarding, and special projects.

On the commercial side, the central question is why the customer returns. If they return for document organization, there may be a support business, but the loyalty thesis still needs proof. If they return for a favorable label regardless of the result, the business becomes morally and economically vulnerable. If they return because the report usefully changes approvals and commitments, the product has a meaningful foundation.

Risks that warrant stopping or changing direction

Risk	Early signal	Recommended decision
No willingness to pay	Strong interest, but no orders for real cases.	Change the offering or niche before further development.
Excessive noise	The team spends more time checking alerts than it saves.	Narrow the task; do not hide problems behind an aggregate score.
Human cost too high	Most cases consistently exceed the allotted time.	Reprice, standardize, or leave the segment.
Independence rejected	The customer asks for unfavorable findings to be removed.	Reject the condition; at most offer correctly labeled editorial assistance.
Access blocked	The necessary documents cannot be provided legitimately.	Use another data flow, an economically justified installation, or decline the case.
Commercial concentration	One customer can dictate the standard because they fund almost everything.	Limit their influence and diversify before institutionalizing the model.
Commoditized product	An internal evaluator delivers the same value at a lower cost.	Specialize, integrate, or change the revenue model.

What an investor should ask for

An investor should see complete cases, including errors and appeals, not just the best screenshots. They should be able to reconcile revenue with invoices, delivery time with costs, and the number of customers with free participants. They should test a situation in which the report was unfavorable to the buyer and examine what happened.

For an investment in the startup, retention, contribution after human labor, and distribution capacity matter. For an investment in the infrastructure of a decentralized brand, the relevant factors are

the number of economically active operators, shared revenue, the cost of the standard, and the real possibility of replacing the technology provider. These are two different evaluations.

The investment conclusion supports a bounded commercial experiment, not premature expansion. Anti-Smoothing could become a valuable service if it makes commitments more credible and decisions more intelligible without creating a new opaque authority. The business is built from paid cases and repeat relationships; a decentralized brand becomes useful when it provides broader coverage and greater independence than one company can efficiently deliver.

Appendix A. What a marketable report looks like

Entirely synthetic demonstration case. It does not describe a real customer, project, or result. Its purpose is to illustrate the deliverable, not to demonstrate a system's performance.

The mandate

A supplier and a buyer are considering expanding an AI assistant for B2B support. Their shared question is whether the pilot results support expansion to 12,000 requests per month. The review covers proposal v1, the pilot protocol, the results table, the issue log, and the acceptance minutes. It does not examine the complete code, infrastructure security, or data that were not provided.

Synthetic sources

ID	Document and relevant excerpt
S1	Proposal v1, §3: “The pilot covers English-language requests for category A; returns are excluded.”
S2	Results, table 2: 300 requests evaluated; 252 passed the acceptance rubric; 90 involved human editing. The overlap between the two groups is not specified.
S3	Issue log, issue 17: integration with the customer’s system is blocked until test access is provided.
S4	Minutes, §5: the customer promised test access on June 4 and granted it on June 13.
S5	Executive report, §1: “The solution autonomously resolves 84% of requests and is ready for full expansion.”
S6	Protocol, §7: no tests were run at the proposed monthly volume; cost per case includes only model calls.

Decision conclusion

The data allow a bounded pilot to be evaluated, but they do not yet support the wording in the executive report. Expansion can be discussed as a conditional stage, with a measurement of autonomous resolution, volume tests, and human labor included in the cost. The available sources do not allow the integration delay to be attributed solely to the supplier.

This is not a recommendation to abandon the project. It is the difference between approving another verification stage and accepting a capability already demonstrated at full scale.

Finding 1 — Accepted outcome versus autonomous resolution

Claim: S5 presents 84% as the autonomous-resolution rate. **Evidence:** 252/300 is indeed 84%, but S2 does not show how many of those 252 requests were resolved without human editing. **Material difference:** acceptance of the outcome is confused with autonomy of the process.

Possible consequence: the buyer may misjudge staffing needs and the cost of the service. **Uncertainty:** the exact number of autonomous resolutions cannot be calculated from the available information. **Action:** separate the four categories—accepted/not accepted and edited/not edited—and then recalculate the metric.

Wording currently supported: “84% of the evaluated outcomes passed the acceptance rubric; the rate of resolution without human intervention requires a further breakdown.”

Finding 2 — Expansion of scope and volume

Claim: readiness for full expansion. **Evidence:** S1 limits the scope and excludes returns; S6 excludes testing at the proposed volume. **Material difference:** the conclusion exceeds the tested population and conditions.

Possible consequence: approval covers cases for which no relevant results exist. **Action:** define an expansion stage with additional data sets, acceptance criteria, and limits on use. **Proposed wording:** “The pilot justifies testing expansion; full operation remains conditional on validation of the additional categories and volume.”

Finding 3 — Dependence on the customer and attribution of delay

Evidence: S3 and S4 show a dependence on access and a delay in obtaining it. **Finding:** there is a documented customer contribution to the blockage. **Limit:** the nine calendar days cannot automatically be turned into nine days of delay for the entire project; information about the critical path and parallel work is missing.

Action: update the shared timeline and separate the intervals affected by each dependency. Do not attribute intent or legal fault. The report must give this finding the same visibility as the supplier's limitations.

Appeal and correction

The supplier submits a new breakdown, S7: 180 requests were accepted without human editing. The reviewer checks the version and changes finding 1: in the pilot set, the demonstrated rate is 180/300, or 60%. This does not establish a rate for all future traffic.

The finding is not erased from the history, but its status becomes "clarified by additional evidence." The current report uses the new value. The customer can approve the next stage on this basis without the product artificially preserving an uncertainty that has already been resolved.

Appendix B. The initial commercial offer

Review of an AI expansion decision — EUR 1,500

For whom: a supplier or buyer of an AI/software project about to accept a stage, expand a pilot, or sign a commitment. **Objective:** identify material differences between the promise, the sources, and the proposed conclusion.

Required documents: the proposal, the decision's scope, success criteria, relevant results, and open issues. The customer confirms that they may lawfully provide the materials. A standard case covers up to 25,000 source words and 20 agreed priority claims.

Delivery: a report with up to five priority findings, an evidence register, coverage limits, clarification questions, and alternative wording. Six expert hours and one round of clarification are included. The proposed turnaround is three to five business days after the case file is confirmed complete; special cases are quoted separately.

Service acceptance criteria: each finding has a located source or is labeled as uncertainty; numerical calculations are verifiable; the customer can contest the interpretation; no favorable conclusion is guaranteed. A complete technical audit, legal opinion, and application security certification are not included.

Commercial terms: 50% on order and 50% on delivery; correction of service errors is included. Any expansion of scope is approved separately. Data are not reused for training or for the shared corpus without explicit consent and rights.

Next product: a subscription is proposed only if updates or decisions recur. A useful one-time review does not oblige the customer to buy ongoing monitoring.

Sources and reference points

The sources support concepts, reference figures, and descriptions of existing capabilities. They do not validate willingness to pay, the proposed product's performance, or the financial scenarios. Online documentation was consulted on September 12, 2026; the years of the statistical data are specified separately.

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